

[illegible]

Rockbox has plenty of plugins

Multi-tasking

Custom firmware has been known to enable multitasking on devices like iPod 2G which have long stopped getting OS updates from Apple.

And more ...

While each custom firmware comes with its own set of features, here is a list of things which are common across various custom firmware projects - high-resolution volume control, equalisers with more parameters than the average person can differentiate between, the ability to turn off irritating features, support for copy-paste, crossfading, greater gain control, emulate applications which would otherwise not be compatible.

Disadvantages

The downside of going custom is pretty much the same for most devices, there is the loss of any claim for warranty. All manufacturers like to put this little clause in their warranty statements which are accompanied by tamper proof seals placed all over the device. Now some of these seals can be peeled off and then affixed back on again after the deed is done. All you need are a hair dryer and some waxed paper. However, there are other ways in which companies can figure out if you've been fiddling around with your device.